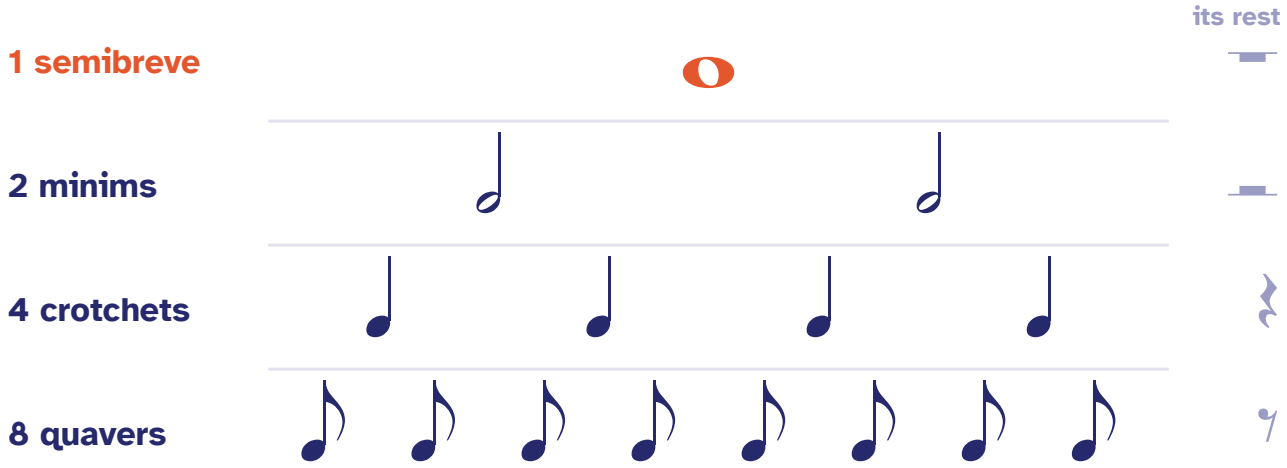
PART II · TIME · 2

Notes and rests

You can see how long a note lasts from its shape: each plain note is **half** the one above it. And every note has a twin **rest**, a silence you count just as carefully.

THE SECRET

Each note is half the one above it, and every note has a rest twin.



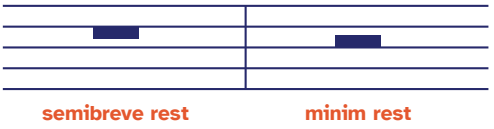
Each note splits into two of the next

Counting quavers: say the beat's number, then "&" halfway to the next beat: "1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &".

Head, stem, flag

The **head** sits on a line or in a space. A **stem** goes up on the right of the head or down on the left. **Flags** on the stem halve the value each time; groups of quavers are joined by **beams** instead of flags.

Which rest is which?

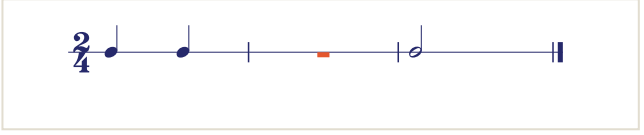


The semibreve rest **hangs** below the fourth line; the minim rest **sits** on the middle line.

THE SEMIBREVE REST'S SPECIAL POWER

Most rests last a fixed number of beats. The **semibreve rest** can also mean **a whole bar of silence** in any time signature: 4 beats in 4/4, but 3 in 3/4 and 2 in 2/4. It is then centred in the bar. No other rest can do this.





PART II · TIME · 2 · CONTINUED

NOTE	REST	NAME	ALSO CALLED	BEATS*	FIRST MET
		semibreve	whole note	**4**	Level 0
		**minim**	half note	**2**	Level 0
		**crotchet**	quarter note	**1**	Level 0
		**quaver**	eighth note	**½**	Level 0
		**semiquaver**	sixteenth note	**¼**	Level 2

Why whole, half and quarter?

Think of each beat as a pizza. A bar of 4/4 is four pizzas. The note that fills the whole bar is the **whole note**; the others are a half, a quarter, an eighth and a sixteenth of it. Two quavers beamed together fill one pizza. A rest is the same share left empty: shaded with lines.

semibreve		whole note	4 pizzas · 4 beats
semibreve rest		silence	4 empty pizzas · 4 beats
minim		half note	2 pizzas · 2 beats
minim rest		silence	2 empty pizzas · 2 beats
crotchet		quarter note	1 pizza · 1 beat
crotchet rest		silence	1 empty pizza · 1 beat
quaver		eighth note	half a pizza · ½ beat
quaver rest		silence	half an empty pizza · ½ beat
semiquaver		sixteenth note	a quarter of a pizza · ¼ beat
semiquaver rest		silence	a quarter of an empty pizza · ¼ beat

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



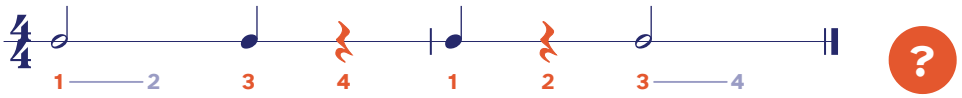
Clap once and hold for 2: a minim.

Now clap four crotchets (1 2 3 4), then one semibreve (clap, and hold all four beats). Say the counts out loud.

PART II · TIME · 2 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

How long is each sound, and each silence?

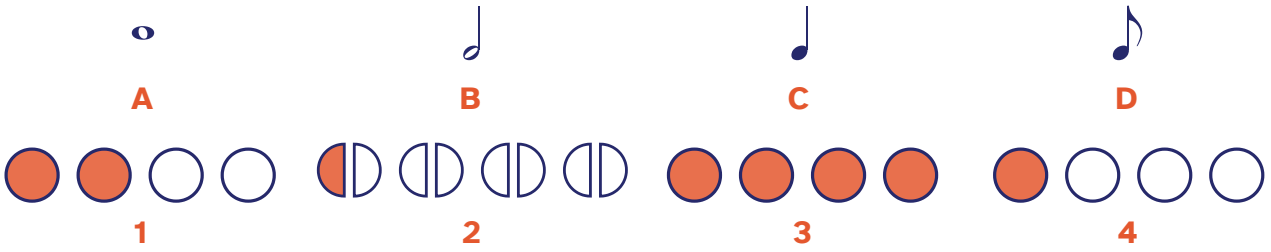


1. **Name each shape** in the bar.
2. **How many beats** does each one last?
3. **Add them up,** rests included. What is the total?

Minim 2, crotchet 1, crotchet rest 1: every bar adds up to **4 beats**, silences included.

GAME

Pizza match

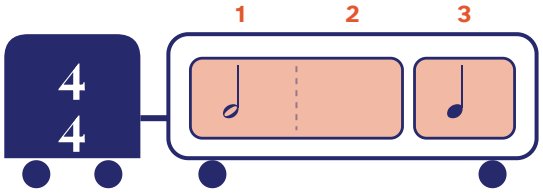


Match each note (A to D) with its pizzas (1 to 4). One pizza is one beat.

Answer: A 3, B 1, C 4, D 2.

EXAMPLE 2

Fill a bar of 4/4: what goes in the last seat?
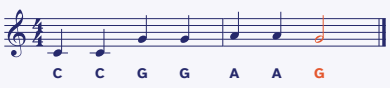


1. **How many seats** does the minim take?
2. **And the crotchet?**
3. **How many seats are left** for a silence, and which rest fills one seat?

2 + 1 = 3, one seat left: a **crotchet rest**. The bar is full.

YOU KNOW THIS

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star



Six **crotchets**, then a **minim** at the end of the line: one beat, one beat … and two beats to breathe.

SEE ALSO
Pulse and the bar p. 46 · How long is a note? p. 52

PRACTISE IT
Workbook Level 0 · Note values · Online: Library › Notes